

TODD ENGLISH

SERIES MEDIA KIT · 2026



FOOD TRIP: INDULGE · THE PHILIPPINES · SEASON ONE · 8 x 30 MIN

A TODD ENGLISH SERIES · EIGHT ISLANDS · ONE QUESTION

FOOD TRIP INDULGE *The Philippines*

Eight episodes, eight Filipino worlds. From the oldest Chinatown on earth to a dinner facing a volcano: extraordinary food, dramatic landscapes, and a culture built around the table.

8 x 30 min

80+ shorts

7,641 islands

Season One · 2026

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Each episode runs five pages: the opener, the run of show, the table, the plates, and the place.

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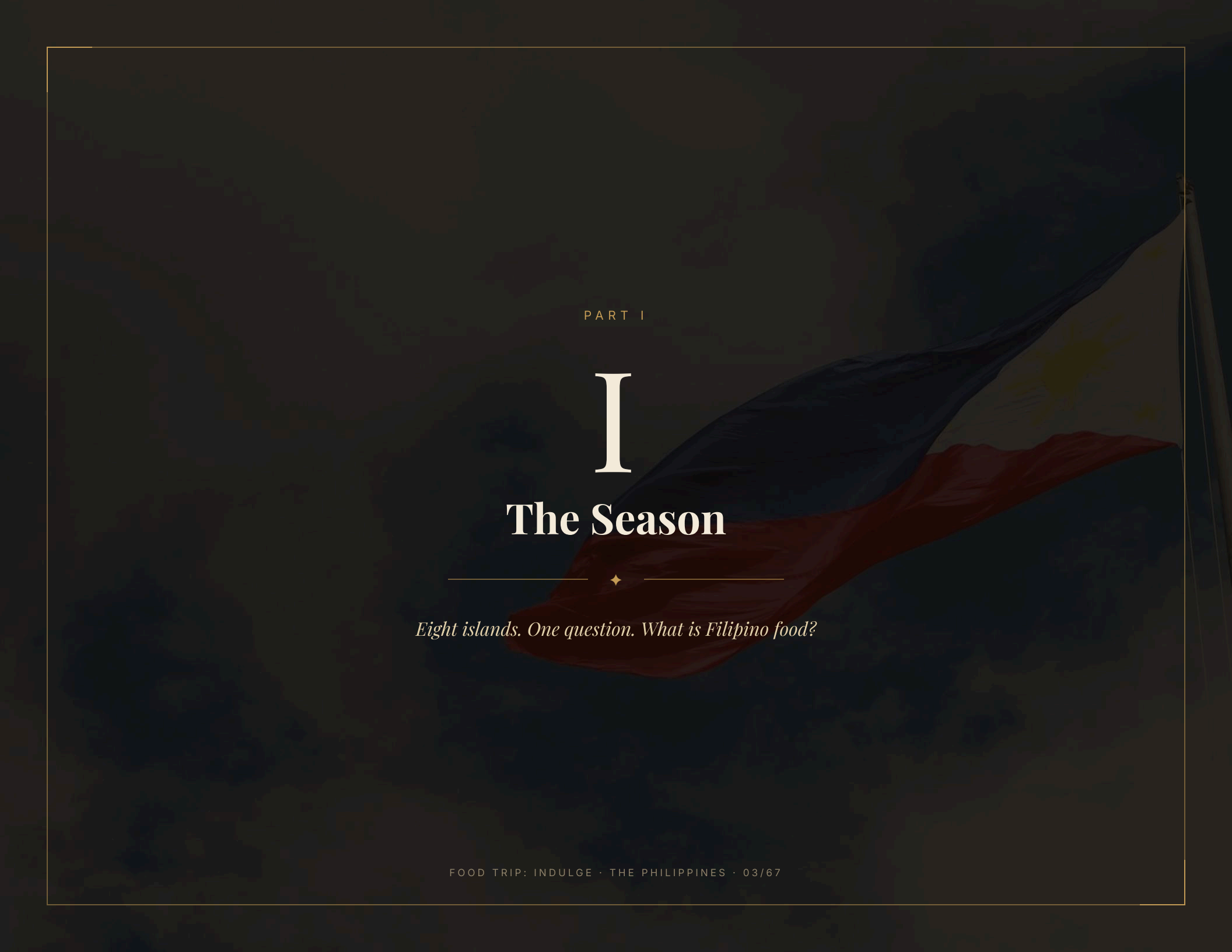
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How to read this kit

Part I is the season. Part II is the culture the show films between meals. Part III breaks down each episode across five pages. Part IV is the machine: shorts, distribution, audience, partners, production.



PART I

I

The Season



Eight islands. One question. What is Filipino food?

the idea

Eight Filipino Worlds

The Philippines can carry a full season because it offers three layers at once: extraordinary food, dramatic landscapes, and a culture built around hospitality and gathering. This is not a conventional travel show. It is Todd English entering eight different Filipino worlds.

Every episode is engineered twice. Once as a 30-minute television hour that moves from a market at sunrise to a spa at sunset, and once as a digital machine: at least ten intentional short pieces per episode, shot during principal photography, never leftovers.

Less a travel show than a series of entrances. Todd English walks into eight places that each cook a different answer to the same question.

The season has a larger question, and it is the emotional spine of the show. Todd arrives in Manila thinking he knows the broad strokes. Every island changes the answer. By the final dinner under a volcano he understands that Filipino cuisine is not one cuisine. It is more than seven thousand islands telling different versions of the same story.

“Occasionally the 78-year-old woman making the greatest adobo you’ve ever tasted should be the celebrity.”

FROM THE SERIES BRIEF

The contrast is the show

\$2 street food → World-class resort

Grandmother’s kitchen → Michelin-level chef

Fishing boat → Private yacht

Market at sunrise → Spa at sunset

Ancient recipe → Todd English interpretation

8

EPIISODES
30 minutes each

80+

SHORT-FORM PIECES
10 per episode, shot on purpose

7,641

ISLANDS
three island groups

10.7M

OVERSEAS FILIPINOS
the second audience

the host

Todd English in the Philippines

A chef who has cooked on four continents, whose last television food trip was Emmy-nominated, and who already feeds Manila.

Todd English is a five-time James Beard Award winner, the chef-restaurateur behind Olives, bluezoo, The Beast and Tuscany, and the co-founder of The English Hospitality Group. On television he has been a fixture for twenty-five years, from *Cooking In with Todd English* to *Iron Chef* and the PBS travel series **Food Trip with Todd English**, which earned him a Daytime Emmy nomination for Outstanding Lifestyle Host in 2008. This series is that format's natural sequel: one chef, one country, eight worlds.

He is not a stranger here. **Pound by Todd English** serves his burgers at SM Mall of Asia, SM Megamall and SM City North EDSA, and his food hall concept opened at SM Aura in Taguig. The audience that queues for Pound is the audience that will watch him learn adobo from a grandmother in Binondo.

The Todd English lens

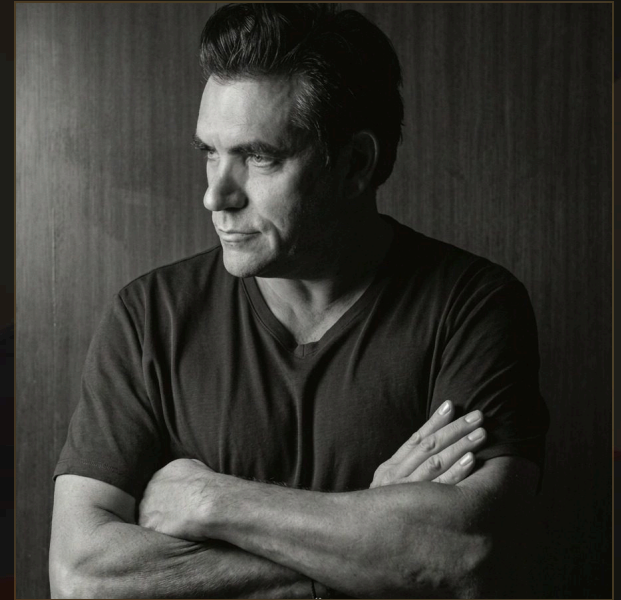
Fire and conviction · rustic Mediterranean technique meets a cuisine built on coals, vinegar and coconut.

Get involved · Todd on the lechon spit, at the batchoy pot, on the fishing boat, not on the sidelines.

The twist · every episode ends with Todd and a local chef reinterpreting what they learned, plated new.

Humour · "Can Todd handle Bicol?" The chili gets hotter; the show gets funnier.

Respect · the grandmother is the celebrity; the chef is the student.



Quick facts

Awards · 5 James Beard Awards; Bon Appétit Restaurateur of the Year

TV · PBS Food Trip with Todd English, Daytime Emmy nominee 2008

In the Philippines · Pound by Todd English, SM malls

Reach · @cheftoddenglish

why now

The Filipino Food Moment

Filipino food has stopped being a secret. The guides, the lists and the tourism board all arrived at the same time, and none of them has a television series yet.

Michelin arrives, 2025

The inaugural MICHELIN Guide Manila & Environs and Cebu was unveiled on 30 October 2025: one two-star restaurant, eight one-stars, 25 Bib Gourmands, 108 establishments in all.

Asia’s 50 Best

Toyo Eatery in Makati ranked No. 42 on Asia’s 50 Best Restaurants 2025 and was named the Philippines’ best restaurant for the sixth time.

UNESCO Creative Cities

Baguio (crafts, 2017), Cebu (design, 2019), Iloilo (gastronomy, 2023). Two of the three are episodes of this season.

Filipino Food Month

Every April, by Presidential Proclamation 469 (2018): a national platform the series can premiere into.

Love the Philippines

The Department of Tourism’s campaign since 2023, with 2026 targeting 6.4–6.8 million arrivals after 5.6 million in 2025. Food is the lever they have not fully pulled.

The diaspora is watching

10.7 million overseas Filipinos; the world’s first Michelin-starred Filipino restaurant is in Chicago. Home is trending.

What nobody has made yet

A chef-led series that treats Filipino food as eight cuisines rather than one list of dishes.

A luxury frame for a country usually sold as budget travel: resorts, yachts, private dining, spa.

A diaspora product built for the 10.7 million who watch from abroad, not only for visitors.

Ready-made premiere moments

April · Filipino Food Month, a national platform for a launch.

January · Sinulog, Dinagyang and Ati-Atihan give three episodes a festival spine.

October · the annual Michelin Guide ceremony in Manila; the Manila episode’s chefs are on that list.

108

MICHELIN ESTABLISHMENTS
Manila & Cebu, 2026 guide

3

UNESCO CREATIVE CITIES
two of them in this season

95.8M

SOCIAL MEDIA IDENTITIES
4h 50m a day, 2nd in the world

5.6M

INTERNATIONAL ARRIVALS 2025
DOT target 2026: 6.4–6.8M

the route
The Season on a Map



1 MANILA: OLD SOUL, NEW CITY
Luzon · Metro Manila (National Capital Region) · The season's arrival city

2 PAMPANGA: WHERE FILIPINO COOKS GO TO EAT
Luzon · Pampanga · 1.5–2 h drive via NLEX–SCTEX

3 CEBU: FIRE, PIG & SEA
Visayas · Cebu · 1 h 30 direct flight

4 BOHOL: FARM, SEA & CHOCOLATE HILLS
Visayas · Bohol · 1 h 20–1 h 40 direct flight

5 ILOILO: THE FOOD CITY
Visayas · Iloilo (Panay Island) · 1 h 15–1 h 30 direct flight

6 BORACAY: THE INDULGENCE EPISODE
Visayas · Aklan (Municipality of Malay) · 1 h flight, 10-min boat crossing

7 PALAWAN: INTO PARADISE
Luzon · Palawan · Clark–El Nido by air; PPS + 5 h road

8 BICOL: FIRE UNDER THE VOLCANO
Luzon · Albay / Camarines Sur / Sorsogon · 1 h 05–1 h 15 direct flight

the formula

The 30-Minute Episode

Every episode follows the same seven movements, so the audience learns the rhythm and the short-form engine knows exactly where to look.

2' COLD OPEN	3' ARRIVAL / FANTASY	6' THE PEOPLE	6' THE FOOD LESSON	4' INDULGE	6' TODD COOKS	3' THE LAST TABLE	
00:00	02:00	05:00	11:00	17:00	21:00	27:00	30:00

00:00 to 02:00

Cold Open

The most extraordinary visual or bite from later in the episode.

02:00 to 05:00

Arrival / Fantasy

Hotel, landscape, boat, city, villa, spa. The promise of the place.

05:00 to 11:00

The People

Market, farmer, fisherman, grandmother, craftsman. Who feeds this place.

11:00 to 17:00

The Food Lesson

Todd learns a dish or technique from the person who owns it.

17:00 to 21:00

Indulge

Spa, diving, sailing, adventure, design, nightlife.

21:00 to 27:00

Todd Cooks

Todd and a local chef reinterpret what they have learned.

27:00 to 30:00

The Last Table

Everybody eats together. The sign-off.

Every ep.

Ten shorts

Shot on purpose inside these seven blocks, never leftovers.

THE RECOGNISABLE SIGN-OFF, EVERY EPISODE

“That’s the trip. This is the taste.”

PART II

II

The Culture

The table is the country. What the show films when it isn't filming food.

the values

Kain Tayo: The Words That Run the Table

Eight Filipino words the series will teach without a glossary, because every episode acts them out.

kain tayo / kumain ka na ba?

"LET'S EAT" / "HAVE YOU EATEN YET?" — THE DEFAULT FILIPINO GREETING

A Filipino host offers food before a guest can even ask, and "have you eaten?" doubles as "how are you?". On screen this is the show's open door: every household, market stall, or boat crew...

bayanihan

COMMUNAL UNITY AND MUTUAL AID, FROM THE IMAGE OF NEIGHBORS LITERALLY CARRYING A HOUSE TO A NEW LOCATION TOGETHER

Bayanihan shows up as a whole barangay pitching in for a fiesta feast, a fishing catch split among boats, or a family's cooking passed hand to hand at a long table. It is the throughline...

pakikisama

SMOOTH INTERPERSONAL RELATIONS; GOING ALONG WITH THE GROUP TO PRESERVE HARMONY

Pakikisama is why a market vendor will underprice a haggle rather than cause a scene, and why Todd will be handed a spoon and expected to try everything offered, refusal being mildly rude....

utang na loob

A DEBT OF GRATITUDE, AN INTERNAL MORAL DEBT REPAID THROUGH LOYALTY RATHER THAN CASH

A grandmother who fed a whole generation of fishermen, or a chef who apprenticed under a mentor for free, describes the relationship in terms of utang na loob, not wages. It is the...

po / opo and mano

RESPECT PARTICLES ADDED TO SPEECH FOR ELDERLY, AND THE GESTURE OF PRESSING AN ELDER'S HAND TO ONE'S FOREHEAD

Any grandmother, market elder, or fisherman patriarch on camera will be addressed with po/opo, and children (and often Todd, if coached) will mano before eating. It is a two-second gesture...

fiesta

THE PATRON-SAINT FEAST DAY, A TOWN'S BIGGEST ANNUAL EVENT: MASS, PROCESSION, AND AN OPEN TABLE FOR ANYONE WHO WALKS IN

Every barangay and town has one, and during fiesta the custom is an open house — strangers are fed. Iloilo's Ep5 and Bicol's Peñafrancia timing (Naga, mid-September) both hang directly off...

pasalubong & the balikbayan box

PASALUBONG: A GIFT BROUGHT HOME FROM A TRIP; THE BALIKBAYAN BOX: THE OVERSIZED CORRUGATED BOX OVERSEAS FILIPINOS SHIP OR CARRY HOME STUFFED WITH GOODS

Every domestic traveler carries pasalubong back to family; every OFW or emigrant fills a balikbayan box for the same reason at a bigger scale. It is the physical, shippable form of the...

merienda / the five meals a day

MERIENDA: THE AFTERNOON (AND SOMETIMES MID-MORNING) SNACK MEAL; THE FILIPINO DAY COMMONLY RUNS BREAKFAST, MERIENDA, LUNCH, MERIENDA, DINNER

Merienda is where the pastries, halo-halo, and street snacks live — a distinct, unhurried meal, not a between-meals nibble. It gives the format a built-in fifth beat per day beyond the...



Black Nazarene procession crowd, Quiapo, Manila, Ep1

How the show uses them

Kain tayo opens every Last Table.

Lola is the celebrity when there is no celebrity.

Pasalubong is what Todd carries from island to island: the through-line prop.

Fiesta gives Iloilo, Cebu and Boracay their spine.

how Filipinos eat

The Culture of the Table

Not what is eaten, but how. The habits that make a Filipino meal recognisable from across the room.

Kamayan / boodle fight

Eating with bare hands off a banana-leaf-lined table piled with rice, grilled meats, and seafood, no individual plates. Originated as a Philippine military mess-hall practice ("boodle fight") and was adopted...

The rice-and-ulam plate

Rice is the constant; ulam ("the thing you eat with rice") is whatever protein or vegetable dish accompanies it — adobo, sinigang, grilled fish, a vegetable stew. The plate ratio (a mound of rice, a smaller...

Sawsawan — the condiment culture

Sawsawan is the DIY dipping-sauce ritual at the center of the table: suka (cane or coconut vinegar, often spiced with chili and garlic), toyo (soy sauce) with calamansi, and bagoong (fermented shrimp or fish...

Carinderia / turo-turo

A carinderia is a small, often family-run eatery with pre-cooked dishes displayed in trays; turo-turo ("point-point") describes the ordering method — you point at what you want rather than reading a menu. It...

Silog breakfasts

"Silog" (sinangag + itlog, garlic fried rice + egg) is a breakfast template that takes the name of whatever protein precedes it — tapsilog (cured beef), longsilog (sweet sausage), bangsilog (milkfish), tocilog...

Halo-halo & merienda culture

Halo-halo ("mix-mix") layers shaved ice, evaporated milk, and a dozen-plus ingredients — ube, leche flan, sweet beans, jackfruit, pinipig — that the diner stirs together before eating. It is the season's...

Lechon as centerpiece

A whole roasted pig, spit-fired until the skin cracks, is the Philippines' default centerpiece dish for any celebration worth having — and Cebu's version, seasoned inside the cavity rather than glazed on the...

Tuba / lambanog & the karaoke night

Tuba is fermented coconut palm sap, drunk young and slightly sweet or aged and stronger; lambanog is its distilled, much higher-proof cousin, sometimes called "Filipino moonshine." Either one shows up wherever...



Overhead view of a kamayan / boodle-fight seafood spread on banana leaves



Sinulog dancers in the Cebu City street parade, Ep3

the calendar

Faith, Fiesta & Heritage

The festival calendar decides the shooting calendar. Three episodes sit inside a January of drums.

- 3

Sinulog CEBU CITY · THIRD SUNDAY OF JANUARY

Sinulog is a Catholic-indigenous street-dance festival honoring the Santo Niño (Holy Child)...
- 5

Dinagyang ILOILO CITY · FOURTH SUNDAY OF JANUARY

Dinagyang honors the Santo Niño and commemorates the historic pact between Malay settlers and...
- 6

Ati-Atihan KALIBO, AKLAN · RUNS ROUGHLY JAN 10-18, WITH T...

Often called "the mother of all Philippine festivals," Ati-Atihan predates Spanish contact —...
- 2

Giant Lantern Festival SAN FERNANDO, PAMPANGA · MID-DECEMBER

Started around 1904-1908 as a simple religious "lubenas" procession lantern, the parol...
- 8

Ibalong LEGAZPI CITY, ALBAY · AUGUST, ROUGHLY AUG 12-30

Established in 1992, Ibalong dramatizes the pre-colonial Ibalong Epic — the heroes Baltog...

- UNESCO Baroque Churches of the Philippines**
SAN AGUSTIN CHURCH, MANILA

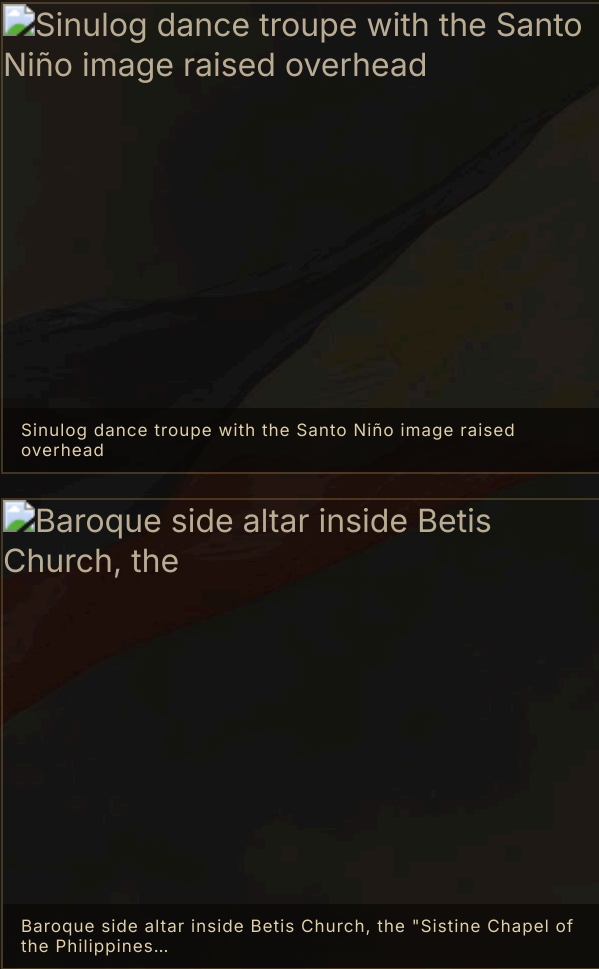
Inscribed by UNESCO in 1993, this four-church group fuses European Baroque design with local materials and earthquake-resistant...
- Betis Church, the "Sistine Chapel of the Phi...**
GUAGUA, PAMPANGA

Santiago Apostol Parish Church, built in 1607, is famous for wall-to-ceiling trompe-l'oeil murals originally painted by Simón...
- Basilica del Santo Niño**
CEBU CITY

The oldest Roman Catholic church in the country, built on the site where Magellan's expedition gifted the Santo Niño image in...
- Loboc Church**
LOBOC, BOHOL

San Pedro Apostol Church sits on the Loboc River, the same river Bohol's floating-restaurant river cruises use, and is closely...
- Molo Church**
MOLO DISTRICT, ILOILO CITY

Santa Ana Parish Church, a rare neo-Gothic Philippine church (built 1831), is nicknamed "the women's church" for depicting only...



the makers

Craft, Language & First Peoples

Meet the Maker is one of the eight short formats. These are the makers.

CRAFT

Cebu furniture & design

CEBU · EP 3

Cebu's furniture industry, built on woven rattan and natural materials, produced...

Betis woodcarving

BETIS, GUAGUA, PAMPANGA · EP 2

The same Betis district famous for its "Sistine Chapel" church is a historic woodcarving center...

Parol lantern making

SAN FERNANDO, PAMPANGA · EP 2

San Fernando's giant-lantern makers build kaleidoscopic parol up to 15+ feet across, using...

Iloilo hablon & Aklan piña weaving

HABLON: MIAG-AO, ILOILO; PIÑA: AKLAN PROVINCE (THE BORACAY GATEWAY) · EP 5

Hablon is a handloom-woven textile (cotton, piña, or jusi fiber) centered in Miag-ao. Aklan's...

Bohol loom weaving & Tubigon baskets

BOHOL, ESPECIALLY TUBIGON · EP 4

Bohol's rural weaving traditions — backstrap and treadle-loom textiles, plus Tubigon's buri and...

LANGUAGE & MUSIC

130+ languages, one archipelago

The Komisyon sa Wikang Filipino's language atlas identifies roughly 130 native languages across the country...

Filipino and English, the two official languages

The 1987 Constitution names Filipino (a standardized form of Tagalog, spoken natively by tens of millions and...

The regional tongues of the eight episodes

Each episode sits in a different home language: Tagalog (Manila), Kapampangan (Pampanga), Cebuano/Bisaya (Cebu, Bohol)...

Taglish, and the soundtrack of everyday life

Code-switching between Tagalog and English ("Taglish") is the default register of urban conversation and is authentic...

FIRST PEOPLES

Ati

AKLAN PROVINCE, INCLUDING A SMALL ANCESTRAL-DOMAIN ENCLAVE ON BORACAY ITSELF · EP 6

The Ati are widely regarded as among the earliest inhabitants of Panay and the Boracay area. Their Boracay...

Tagbanua (Calamian Tagbanwa)

CORON AND THE CALAMIANES GROUP, NORTHERN PALAWAN · EP 7

The Calamian Tagbanwa hold one of the Philippines' only formally recognized "ancestral waters" claims — a...

Badjao / Sama-Bajau

COASTAL ENCLAVES ACROSS THE VISAYAS, MINDANAO AND PALAWAN, HISTORICALLY CENTERED ON THE SULU ARCHIPELAGO

Traditionally houseboat-dwelling sea nomads (the term "Badjao" is considered an outsider label many prefer...

Kenneth Cobonpue's Dragontail table lamp, handmade in Cebu, Ep3

Kenneth Cobonpue's Dragontail table lamp, handmade in Cebu, Ep3

A rule for the show

Indigenous communities appear on their own terms: consent first, credit on screen, and a fee for access. The luxury frame never films over them.

the look

The Philippines in Pictures

Markets, boats, fiestas, kitchens and streets: the visual world the series moves through between meals.

Devotees carry a flower-decked Black Nazarene float through a barangay street



Bangka outrigger boat beached on the sand, palm-lined bay behind it



Steel trays of grilled pork and sinuglaw at a carinderia eatery



A man husks coconuts by hand beside a family-sized copra pile



Night-market fruit stand with pineapples, mangoes, and dragon fruit for shakes



Market stall piled with mangoes, watermelon, grapes, and lanzones

the street

The Philippines in Pictures, continued

What the second unit shoots while the main unit cooks.



Halo-halo with ube ice cream, leche flan, and sprinkles in a glass



A loaded bowl of halo-halo with shaved ice, fruit, and pinipig



A horse-drawn kalesa waits at the curb outside a town grocery



Whole spit-roasted lechon manok chickens rest on banana leaf



Fresh eggplant and okra piled at a wet-market vegetable stall



A palengke market alley lined with colorful umbrella-covered stalls

the table

The Philippines in Pictures, continued

What the second unit shoots while the main unit cooks.



Hapao rice terraces stepping down a mountain valley, Ifugao



Farmers carry a pig on a pole along the Hapao rice terraces



A street vendor tends his cart of bottled drinks under an umbrella, Manila



A fishball vendor fries orange street snacks from his cart



A line of motorcycle tricycles carries riders through a plaza, Laoag



Dinagyang Festival contingent, Iloilo City, Ep5

PART III

III

The Episodes

Manila · Pampanga · Cebu · Bohol · Iloilo · Boracay · Palawan · Bicol

01

EPISODE 1 OF 8 · LUZON

MANILA: OLD SOUL, NEW CITY

Two Manilas in one meal: the world's oldest Chinatown and the country's newest skyline.



REGION

Metro Manila

Metro Manila (National Capital Region)

GATEWAY

NAIA, Manila

The season's arrival city

BEST MONTHS

Nov – Apr

Dry season; Jan–Apr driest and coolest. Wet season Jun–Nov brings street flooding in Binondo.

SIGNATURE

Lumpia · Pancit · Siopao

Roast meats · Adobo · Kare-kare · Kinilaw

Manila is the thesis statement. A city of fourteen million that eats Chinese, Spanish, American and Malay in the same meal, sometimes on the same plate. The episode moves between two Manilas: the 1594 Chinatown where Filipino-Chinese cooking was born, and the glass towers where a new generation of chefs is rewriting it.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ The opening statement of the season
- ✦ Binondo: the oldest Chinatown in the world, founded 1594
- ✦ Contemporary Filipino dining at its most serious
- ✦ The skyline that sells the Indulge promise

the episode

Manila: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

The halo-halo in extreme close-up: shaved ice, ube, leche flan, a spoon breaking through. Todd's face. Cut to black.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

Skyline from the air at golden hour; hotel arrival; a cocktail with the city below. "I think I know this food."
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

Ongpin Street at 7 a.m. with a Binondo historian or chef: the estero, fried siopao, the roast-meat windows, and the Filipino-Chinese family that has cooked here for generations.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

In the family's kitchen: adobo their way, kare-kare's peanut sauce, lumpia rolled by hand. Todd learns that vinegar, not soy, is the spine.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

A rooftop pool, a private tasting with one of Manila's serious contemporary chefs, and the after-dark side of the city.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Chef and Todd plate old Manila new: adobo-glazed short rib, charred eggplant, crispy garlic, coconut-vinegar jus.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

An extravagant rooftop or private-dining dinner overlooking Manila; the Binondo family, the chef and the historian at one table.

Shorts from this episode

- 5 bites in Binondo
- Todd tries halo-halo
- What exactly is adobo?
- Todd makes adobo in 60 seconds



Spicy chicken adobo pieces glazed dark, plated with fresh green...



Classic pork-and-potato adobo with bay leaf, whole garlic and...

The culture beat

- **Binondo's Tsinoy identity** · The world's oldest Chinatown, founded 1594 across the Pasig from Intramuros for Catholic...
- **The Black Nazarene (Quiapo)** · The January 9 Traslacion procession draws millions of barefoot devotees around the...

the food

Manila: The Table

- 01 **Lumpia**

Fresh or fried spring roll wrapped in a thin crepe, filled with vegetables and/or meat.
- 03 **Siopao**

Steamed bun filled with meat, closely related to the Chinese baozi.
- 05 **Adobo**

Meat (usually pork and/or chicken) braised in vinegar, soy sauce, garlic, bay leaf and peppercorn.
- 07 **Kinilaw**

Raw fish or seafood "cooked" in vinegar and citrus — the Filipino answer to ceviche.

- 02 **Pancit**

Stir-fried noodles, typically with vegetables, meat and/or shrimp.
- 04 **Roast meats (lechon macau / Chinese roast duck & pork)**

Chinese-style roasted duck, pork belly (lechon macau) and char siu, sold whole or by the kilo from Binondo...
- 06 **Kare-kare**

Oxtail and vegetable stew in a thick peanut sauce, served with sautéed shrimp paste (bagoong) on the side.
- 08 **Halo-halo**

Shaved ice dessert with mixed sweet beans, fruits, jellies, ube (purple yam) ice cream and leche flan...

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

Todd's twist

THE REINTERPRETATION

Adobo-glazed short rib, charred eggplant, crispy garlic, coconut vinegar jus.

The last table

Extravagant rooftop or private-dining dinner overlooking Manila.

Did you know

Binondo was founded in 1594 by Spanish Governor-General Luis Pérez Dasmariñas as a settlement for Catholic Chinese traders, and is recognized as the...

Intramuros, the Spanish walled city, was founded June 24, 1571 by Miguel López de Legazpi and served as the capital of the Spanish East Indies until...

The MICHELIN Guide made its Philippine debut in October 2025 (the 2026 guide), naming one 2-star and eight 1-star restaurants across Manila and Cebu...

the food, seen
Manila: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



Lumpia · Tray of crispy fried lumpia rolls, golden wrappers, close-up.



Pancit · Pancit canton noodles with shrimp, pork and snow peas on a platter.



Siopao · Steamer basket full of freshly steamed white siopao buns.



Roast meats (lechon macau / Chinese roast duck & pork)
· Sliced roast duck and pork over rice with bok choy.



Adobo · Spicy chicken adobo pieces glazed dark, plated with fresh green chili.

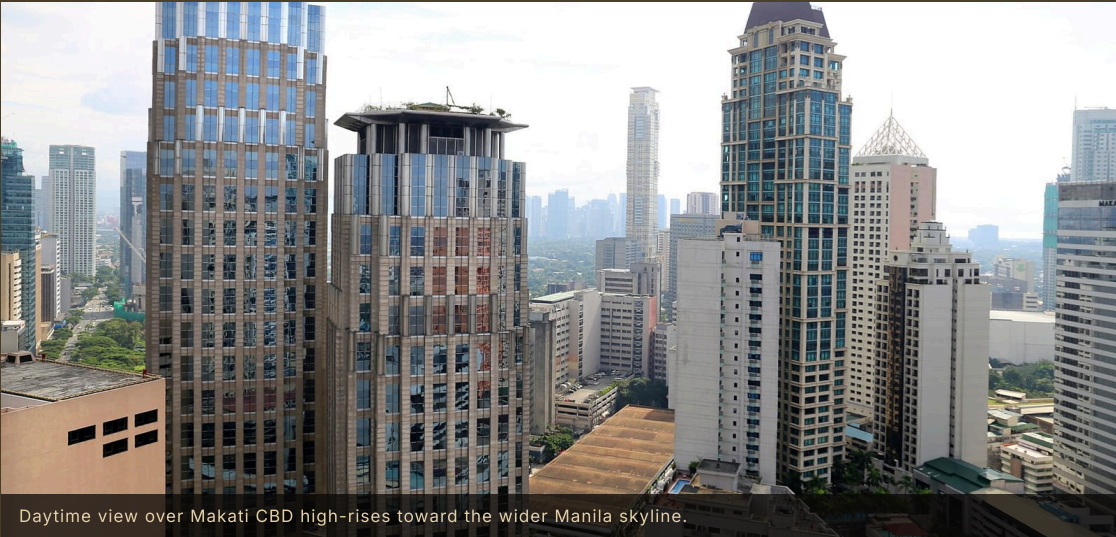


Kare-kare · Kare-kare tray with eggplant, string beans and meat in thick peanut sauce, rice...

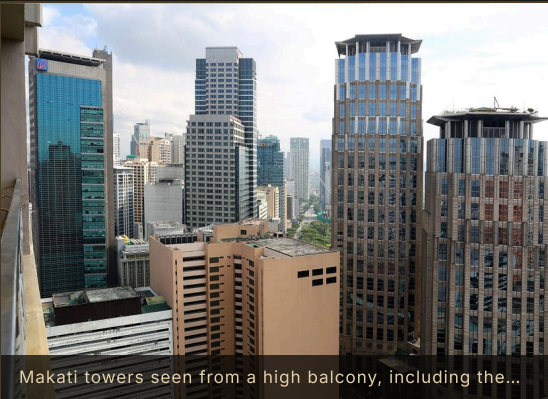
the locations

Manila: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Daytime view over Makati CBD high-rises toward the wider Manila skyline.



Makati towers seen from a high balcony, including the...



Evening courtyard scene inside Intramuros with Spanish...

Culture on camera

Binondo's Tsinoy identity · The world's oldest Chinatown, founded 1594 across the Pasig from Intramuros for...

The Black Nazarene (Quiapo) · The January 9 Traslacion procession draws millions of barefoot devotees around the...

Intramuros vs. Makati skyline · Walking the walled Spanish city against the glass towers a few kilometers away...

The people & places

Ivan Man Dy · Founder of Old Manila Walks; has led the "Big Binondo Food Wok"...

Jordy Navarra · Toyo Eatery, One Michelin Star (2026 inaugural PH guide)...

Chele González · Gallery by Chele, One Michelin Star + Green Star (2026)...

Indulge

Raffles Makati · All-suite luxury hotel in Makati CBD with butler service...

The Peninsula Manila · Landmark 5-star hotel at Ayala Ave/Makati Ave, center of...

Shangri-La The Fort, Manila · 5-star hotel in the heart of BGC with Filipino-accented...

Binondo	Old-Manila spine of the episode: the historian/food walk, the Chinese-Filipino...	Ongpin Street	"5 bites in Binondo" short — walk-and-eat spine shot.	Intramuros	Old-vs-new establishing context; cutaway from Binondo before crossing into...
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02

EPISODE 2 OF 8 · LUZON

PAMPANGA: WHERE FILIPINO COOKS GO TO EAT

Culinary credibility beyond the beach — the province where the country's cooks go to eat.



REGION

Pampanga

Pampanga

GATEWAY

Clark (CRK) or by road

1.5–2 h drive via NLEX–SCTEX

BEST MONTHS

Nov – May

Cooler Dec–Feb; the Giant Lantern Festival lights San Fernando the week before Christmas.

SIGNATURE

Sisig · Kare-kare · Tocino

Bringhe · Tibok-tibok · Panecillos de San Nicolas · Turrone de Casuy

An hour north of Manila is the province Filipino cooks talk about the way Italians talk about Emilia-Romagna. Kapampangan food is the country's most technical: slow, precise, unafraid of fat, and preserved almost entirely by women who never wrote anything down. This is the heritage cooking episode, and the one that gives the season its culinary credibility.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ The culinary capital of the Philippines
- ✦ Sisig was invented here, in Angeles City
- ✦ Heritage cooks still working from oral recipes
- ✦ The family table as spectacle

the episode

Pampanga: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

A cast-iron plate hits the table, sisig still spitting. Steam, hands, a grandmother laughing.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

The road north out of Manila: rice fields, Mount Arayat, a heritage house with a kitchen older than the republic.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

A public market at dawn, then an old family kitchen and a cook still preserving traditional Kapampangan technique. Recipes passed orally; the women who kept the cuisine alive.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

Sisig from the pig's head up; bringhe steamed in banana leaf; tibok-tibok set with carabao milk. Todd learns why nothing is wasted, and how a dish changes when it moves into a restaurant.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

Betis, the woodcarvers' town and its baroque church; a heritage-house lunch; the lantern makers of San Fernando.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Composed sisig: charred calamansi, smoked pork belly and crackling, served in crispy lettuce cups. The heritage cook judges it.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

A huge family table under the trees: three generations, twenty dishes, one province. Todd discovers the culinary soul of the country.

Shorts from this episode

- Todd's First Bite: sisig straight off Aling Lucing's original sizzling plate in Angeles
- Cook It With Todd: 90 seconds to plate a composed sisig with calamansi and crackling
- Meet the Maker: Atching Lillian Borromeo presses San Nicolas cookies in a 200-year-old wooden mold
- One Thing I Learned in Pampanga: Todd to camera on why Filipino cooks eat here on their day off



A vendor turns bibingka (rice cake) over charcoal in a roadside...



Sisig plated with red onion rings, calamansi, chicharon and a...

The culture beat

- **Parol makers of San Fernando** · Giant kaleidoscopic lantern workshops feeding the December Giant Lantern Festival — a...
- **The Aeta of the Pampanga uplands** · A displaced-and-resettled indigenous community (post-Pinatubo) with its own foodways...

the food

Pampanga: The Table

01 Sisig

Chopped, grilled and boiled pig face/ears and liver, seasoned with calamansi, vinegar and chili, served...

02 Kare-kare

Oxtail and tripe stewed in a thick peanut sauce with eggplant, banana heart and string beans, served with...

03 Tocino

Pork cured sweet-and-red with sugar, salt and (traditionally) annatto, pan-fried until caramelized.

04 Bringhe

Kapampangan paella-style dish of glutinous rice cooked in coconut milk and turmeric with chicken, pork and peas...

05 Tibok-tibok

A pudding of fresh carabao's milk cooked until it thickens and 'beats' like a heartbeat (tibok), topped with...

06 Panecillos de San Nicolas (San Nicolas cookies)

Delicate, melt-in-the-mouth white flour cookies pressed in ornate wooden molds bearing the image of San Nicolas...

07 Turrone de Casuy

A local nougat of honey, sugar, egg white and cashew nuts, wrapped like candy in edible rice-paper (papel de...

08 Sans rival

A rich layered dessert of cashew meringue (dacquoise) and French buttercream.

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

Todd's
twist

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Crispy sisig lettuce cups, or a composed sisig with charred calamansi, smoked pork belly and crackling.

The last table

A huge family table. Todd discovers the culinary soul of the country.

Did you know

The Philippine Senate approved SB 2797 in December 2024, directing the Department of Tourism to promote Pampanga as the 'Culinary Capital of the...

Lucia 'Aling Lucing' Cunanan pioneered serving sisig on a sizzling plate and opened her Angeles City restaurant in 1974; DOT has credited her with...

Betis Church in Guagua was declared a National Cultural Treasure by the National Museum and NCCA in 2001 and is dubbed the 'Sistine Chapel of the...

the food, seen
Pampanga: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



Sisig · Sizzling sisig with a raw egg cracked in the center, garlic and chili on top.



Kare-kare · Beef kare-kare in peanut sauce with eggplant and string beans.



Tocino · Cured, glazed pork strips on a banana leaf, market-stall style.



Bringhe · Yellow glutinous rice with chicken, wrapped and served in banana leaf.



Tibok-tibok · Tibok-tibok carabao-milk pudding topped with toasted latik, in a tin mold.



Pancillos de San Nicolas (San Nicolas cookies) · Single scalloped San Nicolas shortbread cookie with molded imprint.

the locations

Pampanga: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Betis Church exterior, Guagua - Baroque facade and centuries-old stone perimeter wall.



Betis Church side facade with round window and courtyard...



Illuminated giant lanterns (parul) lined up at night, San...

Culture on camera

Parol makers of San Fernando · Giant kaleidoscopic lantern workshops feeding the December Giant Lantern Festival —...

The Aeta of the Pampanga uplands · A displaced-and-resettled indigenous community (post-Pinatubo) with its own...

Betis: church and woodcarving in one town · The "Sistine Chapel of the Philippines" murals and the woodcarving craft that built...

The people & places

Claude Tayag · Chef, author and cultural advocate for Kapampangan cuisine; runs...

Lillian 'Atching Lillian' Borromeo · Culinary historian and home cook preserving 19th-century...

Indulge

Bale Dutung private degustatio... · Multi-course Kapampangan tasting menu in Claude Tayag's...

City of San Fernando

Market/street beat; the parul (giant lantern) as a visual motif for the cold open...

Angeles City

Sisig origin story - the historian/food-history beat and the Food Lesson.

Bale Dutung (Chef Claude Tayag's home/private dining)

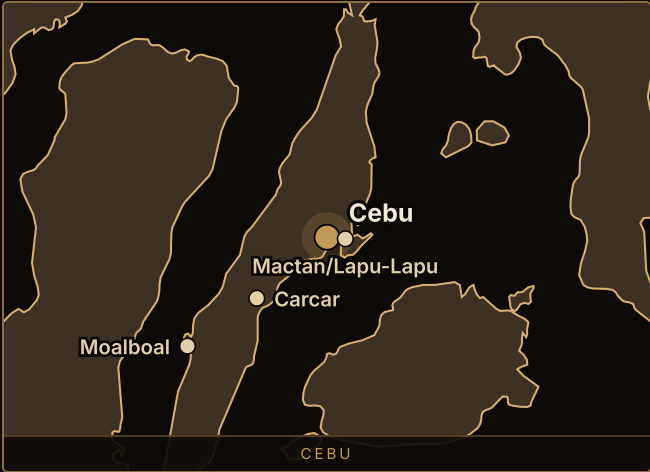
The 'serious contemporary Kapampangan chef' meeting - Todd cooks alongside Tayag...

03

EPISODE 3 OF 8 · VISAYAS

CEBU: FIRE, PIG & SEA

The pig, the reef, and a city that designs with its hands.



REGION

Cebu

Cebu

GATEWAY

Mactan–Cebu (CEB)

1 h 30 direct flight

BEST MONTHS

Jan – May

Least rain; Sinulog fills the city in mid-January, a spectacle or a crowd to avoid.

SIGNATURE

Cebu lechon · Sutukil · Kinilaw

Danggit · Swaki

Cebu is the Philippines at full volume: the roast pig visitors cross oceans for, a working harbour older than the Spanish, and a design scene UNESCO put on the map. This is the episode that smells of smoke. Open with the lechon, then move to the water.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ The lechon capital of the country
- ✦ Seafood cooked at the water's edge, sutukil style
- ✦ UNESCO Creative City of Design
- ✦ Beaches and reefs within an hour of the fire

the episode

Cebu: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

Skin cracking under a knife. A lechon being carved at the fire, sound only.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

Mactan by air; a resort on the reef; the boat that will carry the pig to the beach.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

Before sunrise the lechoneros stuff the pig with lemongrass and garlic and set it over coals for hours. Then the fishermen, the reef fish, the crabs, the dried-fish market.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

The pig from preparation to fire to carving, Todd on the spit, not the sidelines. Then kinilaw at the water: vinegar, ginger, chili, sea urchin if the reef allows.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

A furniture atelier that ships to the world; island culture and craft; a reef dive or the sardine run at Moalboal.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Cebu lechon porchetta with lemongrass, garlic, calamansi and Filipino herb salsa. Or the bao: crispy lechon, liver-sauce barbecue glaze.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

A beach fire dinner at dusk: the pig, the reef fish, the crabs, the crew. One of the strongest shows of the season.

Shorts from this episode

- Would You Eat This? — swaki straight from the shell, spooned with vinegar.
- Cook It With Todd — sutukil in 90 seconds: one fish, three ways.
- Meet the Maker — inside a Cebu lechon house at 4am, from stuffing to spit.
- One Thing I Learned in Cebu — Todd to camera on kinilaw vs. ceviche.



Whole roasted lechon pigs at a Cebu lechon stall, ready for...



Dried fish (dilis, tuyo) for sale by the sack, Cebu market

The culture beat

- **Sinulog & the Santo Niño** · Cebu's biggest festival and its devotional anchor, the Basilica del Santo Niño — the...
- **Cebu design & Kenneth Cobonpue's furniture** · UNESCO Creative City of Design (2019) status gives Ep3 a craft/design beat beyond lechon...

the food

Cebu: The Table

01 Cebu lechon

Whole pig stuffed with lemongrass (tanglad), garlic, green onion, bay leaf, star anise and sometimes saba...

02 Sutukil (sugba-tuwa-kilaw)

One catch cooked three ways at once: grilled (sugba), stewed (tuwa), and 'cooked' raw in vinegar (kilaw).

03 Kinilaw

Raw fish or seafood cut small and 'cooked' in local vinegar with onion, ginger and chili — the Visayan word...

04 Danggit / tuyo / dilis (dried fish)

Sun-dried, salted small fish — danggit is a butterfly-cut rabbitfish fried crisp; tuyo and dilis are smaller...

05 Swaki / tuyom (sea urchin)

Fresh sea urchin roe, eaten raw with vinegar, straight from the shell with a spoon.

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

*Todd's
twist*

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Cebu lechon porchetta with lemongrass, garlic, calamansi and Filipino herb salsa; or crispy lechon bao with liver-sauce barbecue glaze.

The last table

Beach fire dinner.

Did you know

Cebu City was named a UNESCO Creative City of Design on October 30, 2019 — the second Philippine city in the network after Baguio.

Carbon Market has been trading since the early 1900s and hosts roughly 6,000 vendors, making it Cebu's oldest and largest public market.

Sinulog, Cebu's biggest festival honoring the Santo Niño, falls on the third Sunday of January (Jan 18, 2026) and draws 1.5–3 million people.

the food, seen
Cebu: The Plates

The dishes of this episode and the places they come from. Placeholder photography;
principal photography replaces it.



Cebu lechon · Whole roasted lechon pigs at a Cebu lechon stall, ready for carving



Sutukil (sugba-tuwa-kilaw) · Whole fish grilled over charcoal, the sugba (grilled) half of a sutukil meal



Kinilaw · Kinilaw: raw fish cured in vinegar with calamansi, chili and onion



Danggit / tuyoy / dilis (dried fish) · Dried fish (dilis, tuyoy) for sale by the sack, Cebu market



Swaki / tuyom (sea urchin) · Fresh sea urchin roe over rice with wasabi



Magellan's Cross pavilion in Plaza Sugbu, Cebu City

the locations

Cebu: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Outrigger fishing boat at sunset, Visayan coast



Mactan Island beachfront with resort and clear shallow water



Sculptural rattan lounge chair, Cebu furniture-design craft

Culture on camera

Sinulog & the Santo Niño · Cebu's biggest festival and its devotional anchor, the Basilica del Santo Niño —...**Cebu design & Kenneth Cobonpue's furniture** · UNESCO Creative City of Design (2019) status gives Ep3 a craft/design beat beyond...**Lechon Cebu, start to finish** · Cebu-style lechon (seasoned inside the cavity, no glaze) is widely considered the...

The people & places

Kenneth Cobonpue · Cebu-based furniture and product designer whose rattan/abaca work...

Indulge

Shangri-La Mactan, Cebu · Beachfront five-star with a private marine sanctuary...**NUSTAR Resort and Casino / NUS...** · Cebu City's new ultra-luxury integrated resort (opened May...**Sutukil seafood row, Mactan** · Pick-your-catch, cook-it-three-ways lunch near the...

Carcar City

Cold open / lechon origin story — follow a pig from stuffing to spit to fire.

Zubuchon (N. Escario St, Cebu City)

Lechon carving and tasting beat; airport branch is a possible bookend shot.

Rico's Lechon (Cebu branches)

Alternate lechon house for comparison/tasting if Carcar or Zubuchon scheduling...

04

EPISODE 4 OF 8 · VISAYAS

BOHOL: FARM, SEA & CHOCOLATE HILLS

Breathing room: where Filipino ingredients actually come from.



REGION

Bohol

Bohol

GATEWAY

Bohol–Panglao (TAG)

1 h 20–1 h 40 direct flight

BEST MONTHS

Nov – May

Dec–Feb clearest for the Hills;
Jagna's Calamay Festival runs 27–
30 April.

SIGNATURE

Grilled fish in banana leaf • Tableya • Calamay

Peanut kisses • Coconut & root-crop
dishes • Bohol Bee Farm organic
spreads and squash bread

Bohol gives the series breathing room. It is where ingredients come from: cacao drying in the sun, coconut split at the farm, fish wrapped in banana leaf. The Chocolate Hills are the postcard; the farms are the story. Nature, agriculture and quiet luxury.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ Where Filipino ingredients actually come from
- ✦ Cacao, coconut and tropical fruit country
- ✦ A UNESCO Global Geopark island
- ✦ Quiet luxury on Panglao for the wellness beats

the episode

Bohol: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

First light on the Chocolate Hills, mist in the valleys, a drone climbing. Silence, then a rooster.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

Panglao by air; a barefoot villa; sunrise movement on the sand; a farm breakfast.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

A cacao farmer roasting beans for tableya; a coconut climber; the river families of Loboc; a calamay maker.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

A farm cooking sequence rather than another restaurant crawl: grilled fish in banana leaf, coconut-crab-style preparations, local root vegetables, chocolate from bean to cup.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

Massage, diving or snorkelling with the turtles at Balicasag, the tarsiers at dusk, a river at night.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Cacao-rubbed grilled pork with coconut vinegar, green mango and charred pineapple. The farmer tastes his own beans on a plate.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

The whole valley at one table, hills behind. This episode is about origin.

Shorts from this episode

- Todd's First Bite: cracking open a fresh cacao pod at Dalareich and tasting the raw pulp before it's ever chocolate.
- Cook It With Todd: hand-grinding tableya into sikwate the traditional way, 60-90 seconds.
- Meet the Maker: the Dalareich family's chocolate-house story, grandmother's five-kilo hut to bean-to-bar factory.
- Would You Eat This? Todd tries calamay straight from the coconut-shell wrapper in a Jagna market.



The culture beat

- **Loboc Children's Choir** · Founded 1980 at Loboc Central Elementary, now internationally toured — an unexpected...
- **The Chocolate Hills legend** · Local folklore attributes the 1,200+ hills to the giant Arogo's tears for his lost love...

the food

Bohol: The Table

01 Grilled fish in banana leaf

Whole reef or river fish seasoned and grilled wrapped in banana leaf, keeping it moist and imparting a grassy...

02 Tableya / sikwate

Pure roasted-and-ground cacao pressed into tablets (tableya), melted into a thick hot chocolate drink (sikwate)...

03 Calamay

Sticky dessert of coconut milk, glutinous rice and brown sugar (often with peanuts folded in), packed in...

04 Peanut kisses

Small crisp cookies of roasted peanuts and egg white, shaped like tiny chocolate hills.

05 Coconut & root-crop dishes (ube, cassava, taro)

Local root vegetables and coconut worked into snacks, breads and desserts across Bohol's farm towns.

06 Bohol Bee Farm organic spreads and squash bread

Farm-made honey, pesto and vegetable spreads served with house-baked squash bread at the farm's treehouse...

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

*Todd's
twist*

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Cacao-rubbed grilled pork with coconut vinegar, green mango and charred pineapple - using tableya ground earlier in the episode as the dry rub base. (Alternate: a plated dessert built around calamay and fresh Dalareich chocolate.)

The last table

A quiet, unhurried sunset dinner on a cliffside terrace above Panglao (Amorita or Eskaya) - the counterpoint to the earlier open-air farm table, closing the episode's 'farm to indulge' arc.

Did you know

In May 2023 UNESCO designated the whole of Bohol Island the Philippines' first UNESCO Global Geopark - 8,808 sq km of land and marine protected area.

The Chocolate Hills number roughly 1,200-1,700+ grass-covered karst mounds depending on counting method (UNESCO's own geopark site cites 1,268)...

Loboc Church (Church of St. Peter the Apostle) traces to 1596 and was first built in stone in 1602; its bell tower collapsed in the 2013...

the food, seen
Bohol: The Plates

The dishes of this episode and the places they come from. Placeholder photography;
principal photography replaces it.



Tableya / sikwate · Tableya (pressed Philippine cacao tablets) served with hot sikwate and pandesal



Calamay · Jagna calamay packed and sealed in a coconut-shell half, Bohol



Coconut & root-crop dishes (ube, cassava, taro) · Molded ube halaya (purple yam dessert) topped with latik



Philippine tarsier clinging to a branch, Bohol



Philippine coral reef and reef fish - illustrative of the diving around Balicasag...



Alona Beach, Panglao, with outrigger bancas at anchor

the locations

Bohol: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Daytime view from the Chocolate Hills viewing deck, Carmen



Alona Beach shoreline, Panglao



Philippine tarsier at rest, Bohol

Culture on camera

Loboc Children's Choir · Founded 1980 at Loboc Central Elementary, now internationally toured — an...

The Chocolate Hills legend · Local folklore attributes the 1,200+ hills to the giant Arogo's tears for his lost...

Village loom-weaving & Tubigon basketry · Quiet, non-restaurant craft that matches the episode's "breathing room" brief —...

The people & places

Philippine Tarsier Foundation staf... · Conservation story and access to the tarsier sanctuary at Corella...

Dalareich family (Dalareich Chocol... · Multi-generational cacao business that began with a grandmother's...

Bohol Bee Farm founders/farm team · Built the organic-farm-to-table model the episode's farm-cooking...

Indulge

Amorita Resort · Cliffside infinity pools above Alona Beach, 98...

Eskaya Beach Resort & Spa · Private-cove resort, no day visitors - the most secluded...

South Palms Resort Panglao · About 1km of private beach frontage, the most direct beach...

Chocolate Hills Complex, Carmen

Cold open / morning arrival visual; sunrise or golden-hour establishing shot for...

Bohol Island UNESCO Global Geopark

Frames the whole episode's nature/conservation angle; on-screen text card

Loboc River

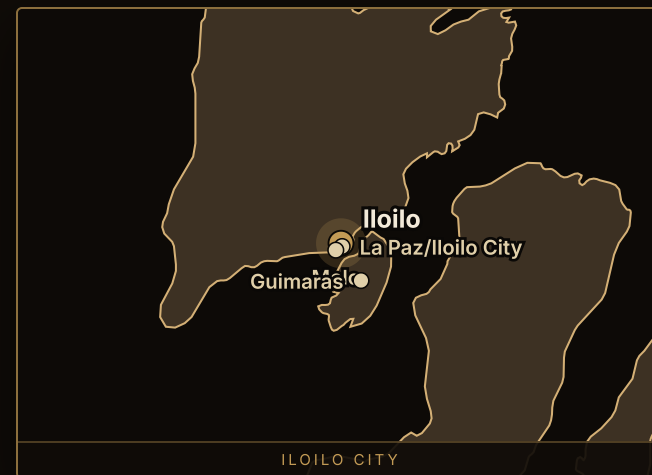
River-culture sequence; lunch-on-the-water scene, grilled fish in banana leaf

05

EPISODE 5 OF 8 · VISAYAS

ILOILO: THE FOOD CITY

A city too small to be famous, until UNESCO named it the food capital of the Philippines.



REGION

Iloilo City

Iloilo (Panay Island)

GATEWAY

Iloilo International (ILO)

1 h 15–1 h 30 direct flight

BEST MONTHS

Nov – May

Dinagyang, the fourth Sunday of January, floods the city with fiesta food for two weeks before.

SIGNATURE

La Paz Batchoy · Pancit Molo · Chicken Inasal

Talaba · Managat · Tsokolate · Biscocho

In 2023 UNESCO named Iloilo a Creative City of Gastronomy, the first in the Philippines. Why a mid-sized river city? Because here food is a civic religion: a noodle soup invented in a market, dumplings named after a district, and a fiesta calendar that never ends. This episode should feel abundant.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy, 2023
- ✦ La Paz batchoy and pancit molo were born here
- ✦ Fiesta culture: long tables, family, music
- ✦ Regional agriculture and the sweetest mangoes next door

the episode

Iloilo: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

00:00 • **Cold Open** 2 MIN
02:00
A ladle of batchoy broth over noodles before sunrise, chicharrón crushed on top, the first slurp.

02:00 • **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN
05:00
The river esplanade at dawn; a heritage hotel; the art-deco façades of Calle Real.

05:00 • **The People** 6 MIN
11:00
The batchoy stalls of La Paz market; the Molo women who fold pancit molo; a family preparing dishes for their fiesta.

11:00 • **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN
17:00
Batchoy from bone to bowl; molo dumplings; native chicken over coals; oysters at the shore; the baked goods of Molo.

17:00 • **Indulge** 4 MIN
21:00
A boat to Guimaras for the mangoes; tsokolate in a heritage house; festival drums if the calendar allows.

21:00 • **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN
27:00
A luxurious batchoy: smoked pork broth, handmade noodles, crispy pork, bone marrow, calamansi. Not fancy for the sake of fancy: how Todd interprets the flavours.

27:00 • **The Last Table** 3 MIN
30:00
The fiesta itself: long tables, music, the whole street eating.

Shorts from this episode

Todd's First Bite: dawn batchoy at La Paz Public Market

Cook It With Todd: folding pancit molo dumplings in 90 seconds

Meet the Maker: the family behind a founding La Paz batchoy stall

One Thing I Learned in Iloilo: why UNESCO called a small city the Philippines' food capital



Tribal dancers in feathered, beaded costume at Dinagyang...



A bowl of La Paz batchoy with egg, offal, noodles and puso rice...

The culture beat

► **Dinagyang** · Honors the Santo Niño and the historic Ati-Malay pact; Iloilo's own festival, timed...

► **Hablon weaving of Miag-ao** · A living handloom-textile craft a short drive from Iloilo City — a visual, hands-on...

the food Iloilo: The Table

01 La Paz Batchoy

Miki noodle soup in pork-and-beef-bone broth topped with crushed chicharon, offal, and raw egg.

02 Pancit Molo

Wonton-style pork dumplings served in a clear chicken-and-pork broth, sometimes with shredded chicken.

03 Chicken Inasal (Ilonggo style)

Native chicken marinated in calamansi, vinegar, ginger and lemongrass, basted with annatto oil and chargrilled.

04 Talaba (grilled/baked oysters)

Fresh oysters from Iloilo Strait, grilled or baked with butter and cheese, or eaten raw with vinegar.

05 Managat (mangrove red snapper)

Whole reef fish, usually grilled or served sweet-and-sour.

06 Tsokolate (batirol hot chocolate)

Thick drinking chocolate whipped to a froth with a wooden batirol whisk, made from tableya (pure cacao tablets).

07 Biscocho / heritage baked goods

Twice-baked, butter-and-sugar toasted bread slices, plus piaya, barquillos and galletas.

08 Guimaras Mango

Sweet, golden carabao mango grown on the island 15-20 minutes offshore.

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

Todd's twist

THE
REINTERPRETATION

A luxurious batchoy: smoked pork broth, handmade noodles, crispy pork, bone marrow and calamansi. Not fancy for its own sake — how Todd interprets the flavors of the original market bowl.

The last table

A long fiesta table loaded with everything the episode touched — batchoy, pancit molo, chicken inasal, grilled talaba, Guimaras mangoes — family, music, and food everywhere, framed as the answer to 'why does a small city get a UNESCO food title?'

Did you know

Iloilo City became the first Philippine city named a UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy, designated October 31, 2023.

Iloilo City has over 300 restaurants employing about 4,600 people in its gastronomy sector.

La Paz batchoy is credited to butcher Federico Guillergan Sr. at La Paz Public Market circa 1938.

the food, seen

Iloilo: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



La Paz Batchoy · A bowl of La Paz batchoy with egg, offal, noodles and puso rice on the side.



Pancit Molo · Pork wonton dumplings in clear broth with scallions, an overhead view.



Chicken Inasal (Ilonggo style) · Grilled chicken inasal plated with rice, palabok, egg and calamansi.



Talaba (grilled/baked oysters) · Oysters on the half shell topped with melted cheese, grilling over charcoal.



Biscocho / heritage baked goods · Four rounds of toasted playa-style flatbread on a griddle.

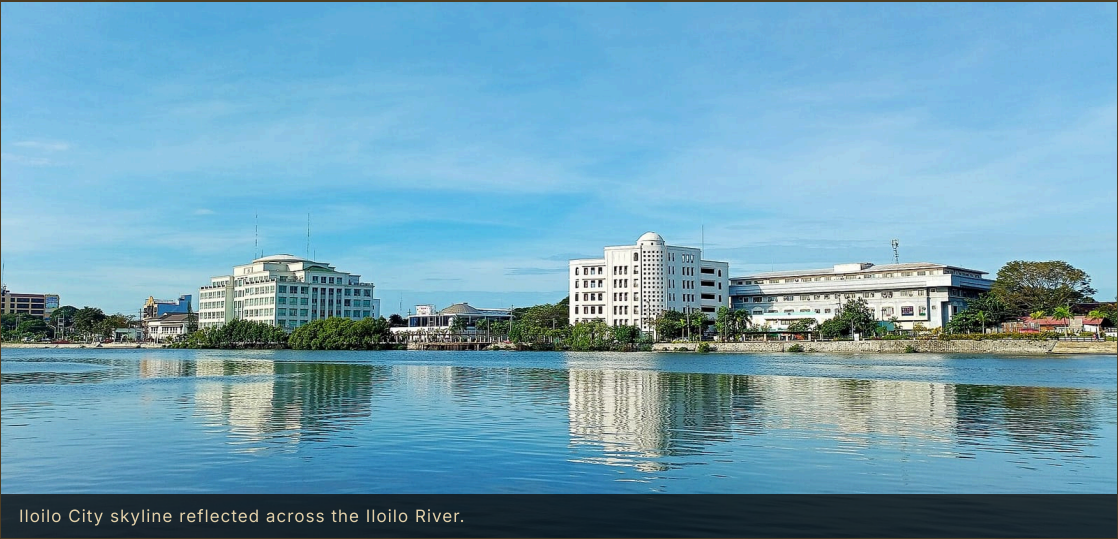


Guimaras Mango · Stacks of ripe golden mangoes piled high for sale at a market stall.

the locations

Iloilo: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Iloilo City skyline reflected across the Iloilo River.



Molo Church illuminated at blue hour.



National Museum of the Philippines - Iloilo, a heritage...

Culture on camera

Dinagyang · Honors the Santo Niño and the historic Ati-Malay pact; Iloilo's own festival, timed...

Hablon weaving of Miag-ao · A living handloom-textile craft a short drive from Iloilo City — a visual, hands-on...

Molo, the "Athens of the Philippines" · A district that was historically Panay's center of learning, with its own...

The people & places

Ted's / Netong's / Deco's batchoy ... · The three founding La Paz batchoy houses, all tracing back to the...

Gerard and Luth Camiña · Present-day stewards of Camiña Balay nga Bato, the 1865 heritage...

Indulge

Richmonde Hotel Iloilo · Business Park base with spa, pool and two bars.

Seda Atria · Modern mid-luxury hotel in the Atria Park District.

Courtyard by Marriott Iloilo · Marriott property in Iloilo Business Park, restaurant/bar...

La Paz Public Market Cold open / morning batchoy scene

Ted's Oldtimer Lapaz Batchoy Todd's first batchoy bite

Netong's Original La Paz Batchoy Alternate/second batchoy stop, market atmosphere

06

EPISODE 6 OF 8 · VISAYAS

BORACAY: THE INDULGENCE EPISODE

Where the Indulge title comes alive — earned with a fishing story, spent on a barefoot table on the sand.



REGION

Boracay Island

Aklan (Municipality of Malay)

GATEWAY

Caticlan (MPH) + banca

1 h flight, 10-min boat crossing

BEST MONTHS

Nov – May

Amihan: flat calm seas on the west-facing White Beach and up to eight hours of sun a day Feb–May.

SIGNATURE

Grilled prawns · Chili crab · Whole grilled fish

Kinilaw · Tropical fruit · Beach barbecue · Inubarang manok

Four kilometres of white sand that the country closed for six months to save. This is where the Indulge title comes alive: paraw sails at sunset, spa, champagne, seafood. Then we earn it, with a fishing boat before light and a market where you buy the catch and carry it to a cook.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ The title episode
- ✦ The most sponsor-friendly hour of the season
- ✦ Buy-the-catch market culture
- ✦ Amihan-season sunsets on White Beach

the episode

Boracay: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

A paraw sail cuts across a red sun. Then, tight: a prawn on the grill, the hiss.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

Shot like a fragrance commercial: white sand, water, breakfast overlooking the ocean, boat, spa, champagne, seafood.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

Out with the fishermen before light; the market where the catch is bought and carried to a cook.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

Grilled prawns, crab, whole fish, kinilaw, coconut, tropical fruit: the beach barbecue, done by the people who do it every day.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

The spa; the yacht; sunset sailing on a paraw; a shell beach with nobody on it.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

The catch goes back to a chef. Whole grilled fish with calamansi brown butter, coconut, herbs and crispy garlic.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

A massive barefoot sunset table on the sand.

Shorts from this episode

- Todd's First Bite: cracking into a just-grilled D'Talipapa crab, feet in the sand
- Cook It With Todd: 90-second calamansi brown butter for the whole grilled fish
- Meet the Maker: a D'Talipapa paluto cook on picking, pricing and firing the day's catch
- Indulge: sunset paraw sail intercut with the Mandala Spa treatment room
- Would You Eat This?: a whole grilled reef fish, head and all, held up to camera



A beached outrigger fishing boat and drying nets under palm...



Fresh mackerel and tuna loin laid out for sale at a Philippine...

The culture beat

- **The Ati community of Aklan/Boracay** · One of the island's earliest peoples, holding a small but real ancestral-domain title on...
- **Paraw sailing** · The traditional double-outrigger sailboat, closely associated with Boracay sunsets — a...

the food

Boracay: The Table

01 Grilled prawns (sugpo/hipon)

Whole tiger prawns or river prawns, split and grilled over charcoal, usually with garlic butter or a calamansi...

03 Whole grilled fish (inihaw na isda)

A whole reef fish (usually tilapia, tanigue/Spanish mackerel or bangus) marinated and grilled whole over...

05 Tropical fruit (mango, pineapple, dragon fruit, watermelon)

Fresh-cut fruit, mango shakes, buko (young coconut) served whole with a straw.

07 Inubarang manok

Native chicken pressure-stewed in coconut milk with ubad (shredded banana pith), lemongrass and a souring leaf...

02 Chili crab / grilled blue crab (alimango/alimasag)

Whole crab either grilled plain or wok-fried in a garlic-chili-butter sauce.

04 Kinilaw

Raw fish or seafood 'cooked' in vinegar and calamansi juice with ginger, onion, chili, sometimes finished with...

06 Beach barbecue (ihaw-ihaw)

Mixed grill of seafood, pork belly, chicken and vegetables cooked tableside over open coals.

08 Chicken binakol

A lighter Aklanon/Iloilo soup: native chicken simmered in coconut water and grated coconut with green papaya...

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

*Todd's
twist*

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Whole grilled fish with calamansi brown butter, coconut, herbs and crispy garlic.

The last table

A massive barefoot sunset table on the sand.

Did you know

President Duterte closed Boracay to all tourists for six months, April 26-October 26, 2018, after a task force found most sewage draining untreated...

Post-rehabilitation rules impose a carrying-capacity cap (widely cited around 19,000 tourists plus 15,000 workers on-island at once) and ban smoking...

New construction and structures (including stages, tables, chairs and beach furniture for events) are barred within a 25m+5m easement from the...

the food, seen
Boracay: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



Kinilaw · Fresh mackerel and tuna loin laid out at a wet market, the raw base for kinilaw.



Whole grilled fish (inihaw na isda) · A boodle-fight spread of grilled whole fish, rice and vegetables on banana leaf...



Chili crab / grilled blue crab (alimango/alimasag) · A pile of whole grilled chili crab on a plate.



Grilled prawns (sugpo/hipon) · Whole prawns grilling over open charcoal, heads and shells charring.



Tropical fruit (mango, pineapple, dragon fruit, watermelon) · Buko salad served in a halved coconut shell with a caramel tuile.



Kinilaw · A plated mound of vinegar-cured fish kinilaw topped with julienned vegetables.

the locations

Boracay: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



White Beach's turquoise shoreline with an outrigger boat under moody sky



Tour boat silhouette crossing the sun at sunset



Colorfully painted paraw sailboats racing under a clear sky

Culture on camera

The Ati community of Aklan/Boracay · One of the island's earliest peoples, holding a small but real ancestral-domain...

Paraw sailing · The traditional double-outrigger sailboat, closely associated with Boracay sunsets...

Ati-Atihan echoes · Kalibo's Ati-Atihan (Aklan's provincial capital, the gateway to Boracay) is the...

The people & places

D'Talipapa market vendors and palu... · The market-to-plate system is the episode's 'earn it' story...

Ati community of Boracay · The island's original inhabitants — a ~42-family, five-generation...

Paraw boat crews (Boracay boatmen'... · Traditional double-outrigger sailors running the sunset paraw...

Indulge

Shangri-La Boracay Resort & Sp... · Flagship 5-star on its own hillside cove at the north end...

Crimson Resort & Spa Boracay · Quieter north-coast cove property, spacious rooms, direct...

Mövenpick Resort & Spa Boracay · Punta Bunga Cove, private beach access; verified operating...

White Beach
(Stations 1-3)

Cold open fragrance-commercial visuals;
Station 1 for the arrival/fantasy beat and...

Diniwid Beach

Quiet contrast beat — a barefoot
breakfast-over-the-water scene away
from the main...

Puka Shell Beach

Texture/detail cutaway; a rougher, more
'real island' counterpoint before the...

07

EPISODE 7 OF 8 · LUZON

PALAWAN: INTO PARADISE

What does food taste like when civilisation almost disappears?



REGION

El Nido / Bacuit Bay

Palawan

GATEWAY

El Nido (ENI) via Clark, or PPS

Clark–El Nido by air; PPS + 5 h road

BEST MONTHS

Dec – May

Calmer seas for lagoon access;
Aug–Oct typhoon risk can shut boat
operations entirely.

SIGNATURE

Kinilaw · Tamilok · Lato

Grilled whole fish · Grilled prawns ·
Coconut seafood curry · Green
mango with calamansi

Palawan is the counterpoint to Manila. The luxury is not chandeliers; the luxury is access to an almost impossible natural setting. Limestone cliffs rising out of jade water, a fisherman who knows which reef, and a fire on a beach with nobody else on it. What does food taste like when civilisation almost disappears?

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ The cinematic masterpiece of the season
- ✦ Repeatedly voted the most beautiful island in the world
- ✦ Fire cooking with very little equipment
- ✦ The deserted-beach dinner is the trailer

the episode

Palawan: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

The boat enters the lagoon. Cliffs on both sides. Nobody speaks.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

An island airstrip; a resort on its own island; Bacuit Bay from the water.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

Fishermen who source snapper, squid and crab; seaweed farmers; the indigenous community that stewards the islands.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

Fire and very little else: whole fish over coals, prawns in the shell, squid on sticks, coconut cracked with a bolo, seaweed straight from the water.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

Kayak into a hidden lagoon; snorkel; a beach reached only by boat; a cliffside sundowner.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Island seafood boodle feast: whole grilled fish, lobster, prawns, charred rice, coconut curry, green mango, calamansi sauces, on banana leaves.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

The dinner happens on a deserted beach as the sun goes down. That is the trailer footage.

Shorts from this episode

Would You Eat This? - Todd tries raw tamilok straight off a mangrove log

Todd's First Bite - the first bite of fire-grilled fish on an uninhabited island

Meet the Maker - a Tagbanwa lato (sea grape) diver in Coron, hand-harvesting seaweed the way her family always has

Indulge - 30 seconds of El Nido Resorts' overwater villas cut against Amanpulo's private airstrip landing



A community boodle-fight table piled with crab, rice and fruit...



An overhead boodle spread of grilled whole fish, rice, mango...

The culture beat

- **Tagbanua ancestral-waters stewardship**
· The Calamian Tagbanwa's 1998 ancestral-waters title (the first of its kind in the...)
- **Cuyonon culture** · Palawan's own indigenous-Visayan-rooted regional language and identity, distinct from the...

the food

Palawan: The Table

01 Kinilaw

Raw fish (often tanigue or tuna) cured in vinegar or calamansi with onion, ginger and chili - the Filipino...

02 TAMILOK

A shell-less mangrove shipworm (not really a 'worm' but a wood-boring clam), extracted from rotting mangrove...

03 Lato (sea grapes)

Caulerpa lentillifera, a bright-green edible seaweed with grape-like beads, eaten fresh with vinegar and onion...

04 Grilled whole fish (lapu-lapu/snapper)

Reef fish grilled whole over coconut-husk or wood fire, usually with just salt, calamansi and a dipping sauce.

05 Grilled prawns, squid and mud crab

Fresh-caught shellfish grilled or steamed whole, sometimes finished in a coconut-chili sauce.

06 Coconut seafood curry

Shellfish or fish simmered in coconut milk with ginger, chili and lemongrass.

07 Green mango with calamansi/salt

Unripe mango, sliced and eaten with salt, vinegar or bagoong (fermented shrimp paste).

08 Charred rice

Rice cooked over an open flame until the bottom layer crisps and smokes, often in a clay pot or bamboo.

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

*Todd's
twist*

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Island seafood boodle feast - whole grilled fish, lobster, prawns, charred rice, coconut curry, green mango, calamansi sauces.

The last table

Dinner on a deserted beach at sundown = the trailer footage.

Did you know

Puerto Princesa Subterranean River National Park was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site on December 4, 1999, and named one of the New 7...

Tubbataha Reefs Natural Park, ~150km southeast of Puerto Princesa, is a UNESCO World Heritage coral atoll at the heart of the Coral Triangle.

The El Nido-Taytay Managed Resource Protected Area covers 360 sq km of land and sea and funds itself through a PHP 200 Eco-Tourism Development Fee...

the food, seen
Palawan: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



Kinilaw · Kinilaw plated with julienned vegetables and a vinegar dipping sauce.



Lato (sea grapes) · A heaping plate of fresh green sea grapes (lato).



Grilled whole fish (lapu-lapu/snapper) · Overhead boodile spread: grilled whole fish, rice, mango and vegetables.



Grilled prawns, squid and mud crab · A whole grilled squid, sliced and fanned, served with garlic mayo dip.



Coconut seafood curry · Shrimp simmered in coconut curry with pumpkin, green beans and chili.



Charred rice · Rice with a crisp, golden scorched crust, wrapped in banana leaf.

the locations

Palawan: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Boat's-eye view of Bacuit Bay's karst islands and clear water.



Nacpan Beach's palm-backed sand, quieter than the main...



A traditional outrigger banca beached at Calitang, next to...

Culture on camera

Tagbanua ancestral-waters stewardship · The Calamian Tagbanwa's 1998 ancestral-waters title (the first of its kind in the...

Cuyonon culture · Palawan's own indigenous-Visayan-rooted regional language and identity, distinct...

Batak & Tagbanua basketry · Rattan and buri basketry and fish traps woven for direct, practical use — matching...

The people & places

Tagbanwa fishing and lato-farming ... · Indigenous Palawan community holding a Certificate of Ancestral...

El Nido banca boatmen / fishing cr... · The outrigger-boat operators who run island hopping and daily...

El Nido Resorts (Ten Knots) sustai... · Operates Miniloc, Lagen and Pangulasian under a...

Indulge

El Nido Resorts - Miniloc, Lag... · Ten Knots-operated private-island resorts inside Bacuit Bay...

Amanpulo, Pamalican Island · The season's ultimate luxury option - 42 rooms/casitas plus...

Deserted-beach fire dinner (Na... · The 'luxury is access, not chandeliers' set piece the brief...

Bacuit Bay

the cold open - boat threading the cliffs at golden hour

Big Lagoon (Miniloc Island)

arrival/fantasy beat - the 'almost impossible natural setting' shot

Miniloc Island Resort

indulge beat - the eco-luxury counterpoint to Manila's rooftop bars

08

EPISODE 8 OF 8 · LUZON

BICOL: FIRE UNDER THE VOLCANO

Sili, coconut milk and pili nuts under the world's most perfect cone — can Todd handle Bicol?



REGION

Bicol Region (Region V)

Albay / Camarines Sur / Sorsogon

GATEWAY

Bicol International (DRP)

1 h 05–1 h 15 direct flight

BEST MONTHS

Dec – May

Clearest volcano views; typhoon belt Jun–Nov, build in weather cover days.

SIGNATURE

Laing · Pinangat · Bicol Express

Pili nuts · Sili · Gata · Kinunot

The season ends under a volcano. Bicol cooks with coconut milk, chili and pili nuts, and it cooks hotter than anywhere else in the country. You taste progressively hotter food through the episode, and that creates the humour. Can Todd handle Bicol? The answer is the finale.

WHY THIS PLACE

- ✦ Mayon, the world's most perfect volcanic cone
- ✦ The chili-and-coconut kitchen
- ✦ Pili nut country
- ✦ An ending with a skyline of fire

the episode

Bicol: Run of Show

The seven movements of the formula, cast for this episode.

- 00:00
02:00

● **Cold Open** 2 MIN

Mayon at dawn, a perfect cone with a plume. A hand crushing siling labuyo into coconut milk.
- 02:00
05:00

● **Arrival / Fantasy** 3 MIN

Legazpi by air, the volcano filling the window; the Cagsawa ruins; a room that faces the cone.
- 05:00
11:00

● **The People** 6 MIN

Farmers harvesting chilies; coconut milk being pressed by hand; a grandmother cooking laing; the pili nut producers.
- 11:00
17:00

● **The Food Lesson** 6 MIN

Laing, then pinangat, then Bicol Express: progressively hotter. Todd learns why coconut milk tames the chili, and why it doesn't.

- 17:00
21:00

● **Indulge** 4 MIN

Bamboo rafts on Sumlang Lake with Mayon behind; a resort island; a whale shark at Donsol if the season allows.
- 21:00
27:00

● **Todd Cooks** 6 MIN

Charred lobster or local fish with Bicol coconut-chili sauce, crispy taro leaves and toasted pili nuts.
- 27:00
30:00

● **The Last Table** 3 MIN

The entire series concludes with a dinner facing the volcano. That is an ending.

Shorts from this episode

Can Todd Handle Bicol? (the episode's running heat-escalation bit, cut as a 60-90s vertical)

Todd's First Bite: Laing vs. Pinangat — what's the difference?

Cook It With Todd: hand-pressing gata (coconut milk) in 90 seconds

Meet the Maker: a Camalig pili nut family (2-4 min)



Pili tarts and candy on a market shelf — the region's signature...



Laing — taro leaves simmered in coconut milk with chili.

The culture beat

- ▶ **The Ibalong Epic and its August festival** · Bicol's own pre-colonial founding myth (heroes Baltog, Handyong and Bantong), dramatized...
- ▶ **Daragang Magayon: the legend of Mayon** · The volcano is said to be the burial mound of a slain princess, with the clouds around...

the food
Bicol: The Table

01 Laing
Gabi (taro) leaves simmered in coconut milk with chili, garlic, ginger and shrimp paste until the leaves turn...

03 Bicol Express
Pork simmered in coconut milk with a heavy dose of siling labuyo (and often siling haba), garlic, onion and...

05 Sili (siling labuyo)
The small, fiery native Filipino chili that Bicolano cooking uses more heavily and more often than any other...

07 Kinunot
Flaked stingray (or occasionally shark) simmered with chili leaves and coconut cream into a shredded, stew-like...

02 Pinangat (na gabi)
The Bicolano original that laing is derived from: whole gabi leaves wrapped around meat, shrimp or fish with...

04 Pili nuts
Canarium ovatum, a native Philippine nut roasted, candied or pressed for oil; Sorsogon is the primary growing...

06 Gata (coconut milk)
Milk pressed from grated mature coconut; used as the cooking liquid for nearly every Bicolano savory dish.

What is eaten here, what Todd learns, and how he answers it.

*Todd's
twist*

THE
REINTERPRETATION

Charred lobster or local fish with Bicol coconut-chili sauce, crispy taro leaves and toasted pili nuts.

The last table

The series concludes with a dinner facing the volcano.

Did you know

Mayon is called the world's 'perfect cone' for the symmetry of its slopes and stands 2,463 m tall.

As of 2026, PHIVOLCS has Mayon at Alert Level 3 (Intensified/Magmatic Unrest) with lava effusion in the Basud, Bonga and Mi-isi gullies; the agency...

Mayon's most violent recorded eruption, in 1814, destroyed the town of Cagsawa and killed roughly 1,200 people sheltering in its church; only the...

the food, seen
Bicol: The Plates

The dishes of this episode as they are actually served. Placeholder photography; principal photography replaces it.



Laing · Laing: taro leaves in thick coconut sauce with a whole green chili, served...



Bicol Express · Bicol Express: pork and green sili strips simmered in coconut milk, at a Legazpi...



Sili (siling labuyo) · Fresh red and green siling labuyo piled at a market stall beside bunched green...



Pinangat (na gabi) · Pinangat na gabi: gabi-leaf bundle in creamy coconut sauce, topped with sliced sili.



Pili nuts · Glazed pili nut candy pieces, glossy and halved, close up in a hand-held container.



Gata (coconut milk) · Fresh coconut milk pooled in a wide metal basin, overhead shot.

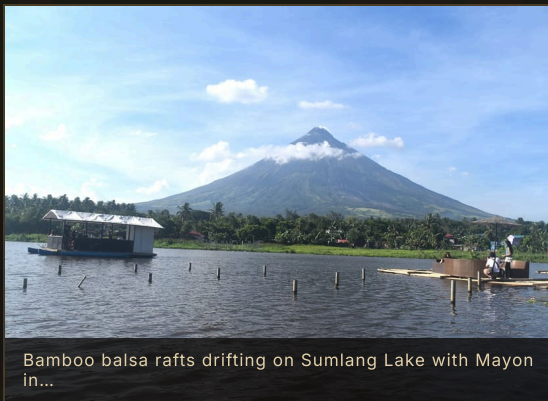
the locations

Bicol: The Place

Where the episode is shot, who it meets, and the culture it films between meals.



Daraga Church's baroque volcanic-stone facade with Mayon rising directly behind it.



Bamboo balsa rafts drifting on Sumlang Lake with Mayon in...



Mayon erupting — an ash-and-pyroclastic plume against blue...

Culture on camera

The Ibalong Epic and its August festival · Bicol's own pre-colonial founding myth (heroes Baltog, Handyong and Bantong)...

Daragang Magayon: the legend of Mayon · The volcano is said to be the burial mound of a slain princess, with the clouds...

Peñafrancia Festival, Naga (September) · One of the country's largest Marian devotions — a fluvial procession down the Naga...

The people & places

A Camalig home cook / grandmother ... · The brief's 'grandmother cooking laing' beat — Camalig's...

A Sorsogon or Albay pili producer/... · Sorsogon is the primary pili growing province and Albay the main...

Indulge

The Oriental Legazpi · 4-star, Mayon-view infinity pool and poolside seafood grill...

Misibis Bay · Private island resort on Cagraray, about 90 minutes from...

Sumlang Lake bamboo raft · A quieter, cheaper indulge beat — floating on a balsa raft...

Mayon Volcano

Cold open and closing dinner backdrop; the visual spine of the episode.

Cagsawa Ruins

The volcano's danger made visible — grounds the 'fire under the volcano' theme in...

Daraga Church (Our Lady of the Gate / Nuestra Señora de la Portería)

Arrival beat — the single shot that says 'Bicol' in one frame: baroque church...



PART IV

IV

The Machine



One production. A television series, eighty short pieces, and an audience that spans the world.

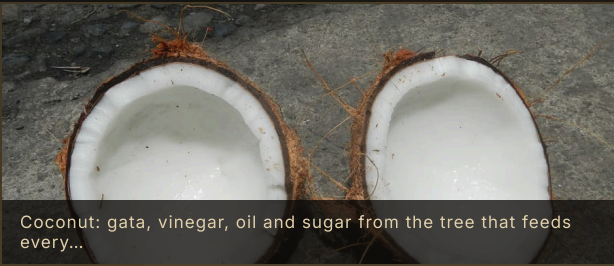
the arc

What Is Filipino Food?

Not eight disconnected tourism commercials. One question, asked eight times, with the answer changing on every island.

Chinese Noodles, dumplings, soy, the roast-meat window. Binondo, 1594.	Spanish Adobo's name, the fiesta table, leche flan, the sausages, the church calendar.	Indigenous Kinilaw, fire, banana leaf, root crops, coconut in every form.	Pacific seafood Reef fish, sea urchin, crab, squid, the boat at dawn.	American Sweetness, canned milk, the burger, the hot dog, halo-halo's ice.	Coconut Gata, vinegar, oil, sugar, the tree that feeds every province.
Vinegar The spine of the cuisine: sour before salt, preservation before refrigeration.	Fire Lechon, inasal, the beach barbecue, the coal-lit street.	Rice The plate every dish is built around, from garlic rice to charred boodle rice.	Preservation Bagoong, tuyo, tocino, tapa: salt, sun and sugar as survival.	Family Recipes carried in hands, not books. The grandmother is the celebrity.	7,641 islands One question, thousands of answers. Each episode changes it.

01	Manila	Todd thinks he knows adobo. He learns vinegar is the spine and Chinatown is the root.	02	Pampanga	Technique. The most exacting cooks in the country, and none of them wrote it down.
03	Cebu	Fire and salt water. The pig and the reef, and design as a way of life.	04	Bohol	Origins. Cacao, coconut and the farm before the restaurant.
05	Iloilo	Civic pride. A city that made food its identity and earned UNESCO's name for it.	06	Boracay	Indulgence, earned. The catch first, then the champagne.
07	Palawan	Access as luxury. Fire on a beach, no equipment, nothing else needed.	08	Bicol	Heat. The final answer: Filipino food is not one cuisine, it is a conversation between islands.



By Episode 8 Todd realises Filipino cuisine isn't one cuisine. It's 7,641 islands telling different versions of the same story. That gives the show emotional intelligence.

the machine

The Short-Form Engine

At least ten pieces of additional content from every 30-minute show, shot intentionally during principal photography. Season One yields roughly eighty standalone digital pieces.

01

Todd's First Bite
Reaction to one iconic dish. One take, one face.

30-45 S

02

Cook It With Todd
One recipe, vertical, hands and heat.

60-90 S

03

Meet the Maker
Farmer, fisherman, grandmother, chef. The cultural story.

2-4 MIN

04

Would You Eat This?
The more unusual food moments, played for the comment section.

15-30 S

05

Indulge
One spectacular hotel, spa or destination shot. Sponsor-ready.

30 S

06

Todd After Dark
Bars, nightlife, late-night street food.

1-3 MIN

07

Chef vs. Chef
Todd cooks with the local chef. The collaboration piece.

3-6 MIN

08

One Thing I Learned in...
Todd direct to camera. The episode's thesis in one breath.

45-90 S



Worked example · Episode 3, Cebu: ten pieces from one shoot day

First Bite · lechon skin at the fire

Cook It With Todd · kinilaw in 60 seconds

Meet the Maker · the Carcar lechonero

Would You Eat This? · sea urchin off the boat

Indulge · the reef villa at dawn

Todd After Dark · Mango Avenue

Chef vs. Chef · lechon porchetta vs. the original

One Thing I Learned · "the pig is an event"

Meet the Maker · a furniture atelier

First Bite · sutukil at the water

Rules of the engine

Shot on purpose · every piece is on the call sheet; none are leftovers.

Vertical first · a second camera frames 9:16 in every food-lesson and first-bite moment.

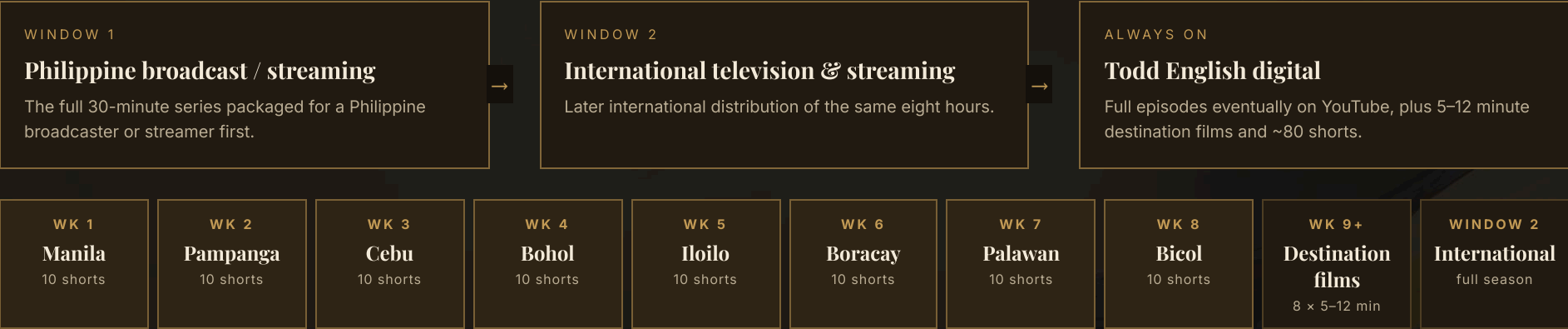
Every maker gets a piece · the grandmother, the fisherman and the carver each leave with their own film.

Sequenced to the island · the week an episode airs, its ten pieces are the only pieces posted.

the windows

Where It Lives

One production with multiple distribution windows.



YouTube	Full episodes eventually, plus 5–12 minute destination films.
YouTube Shorts	Vertical food discovery and personality clips.
Instagram Reels	Luxury, food porn, travel reveals, chef moments.
TikTok	Faster, funnier, less polished Todd moments and food reactions.
Facebook	Still extremely valuable for travel and food content and for Filipino audiences internationally.
The diaspora	Millions of Filipinos live outside the Philippines. Not only “come visit”: “come home through food.”

Season One release plan

Weeks 1–8 · one 30-minute episode a week on the broadcast or streaming partner.

Every day of those weeks · one short piece across Shorts, Reels, TikTok and Facebook, sequenced to the week’s island.

After the first window · eight 5–12 minute destination films on Todd English YouTube; full episodes follow when the window allows.

What each platform gets first

Broadcast / streamer · the eight full episodes, exclusive in window.

YouTube · destination films and Chef vs. Chef.

Shorts & Reels · First Bite, Indulge, Would You Eat This?

TikTok · Todd After Dark and the funniest reactions.

Facebook & iWant · the diaspora edit: Meet the Maker, One Thing I Learned.

come home

The Filipino Diaspora

10.7M

OVERSEAS FILIPINOS

Commission on Filipinos Overseas, 2025

LARGEST COMMUNITIES

United States		4.42M
Canada		0.97M
Malaysia		0.95M

REMITTANCE SOURCES, 2025

United States		39.7%
Singapore		7.3%
Saudi Arabia		6.6%

For the millions who live abroad the series is not a destination pitch. It is the food of home, cooked by the people who never left, with a guest learning it for the first time.

Why it matters to the show

Facebook remains a primary channel for Filipino audiences abroad.

Remittances of \$39.6B a year say how tightly the diaspora stays connected.

Filipino food is rising in the US: Michelin stars, mainstream adobo, a generation of Filipino-American chefs.

Social media: Filipinos are among the world's heaviest users at 4h 50m a day.

Balikbayan · the homecoming is a cultural institution; the series is a homecoming you can stream.

The Filipino food moment abroad

Kasama, Chicago · the world's first Michelin-starred Filipino restaurant (2022), since promoted to two stars.

California · 1.7 million Filipino Americans, about 38% of the US total; Hawaii has the highest share of any state.

iWant (formerly iWantTFC) · ABS-CBN's diaspora streaming service, still operating in 2026: a ready window.

*“Not only come visit the Philippines.
It’s come home through food.”*

Sources: Commission on Filipinos Overseas, Compendium of Statistics 2025 (10.7M overseas Filipinos); Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas 2025 (personal remittances \$39.62B, cash \$35.63B); DataReportal Digital 2026: Philippines (95.8M social identities, 4h 50m/day); Michelin Guide; Neilsberg / US Census.

the partners

Sponsor-Ready by Design

The Arrival and Indulge movements of every episode are built for brand integration; Boracay is the most sponsor-friendly hour of the season.

01 Resorts & hotels Every Arrival and Indulge block is a resort placement: villa, spa, breakfast over the water.	02 Airlines Eight arrivals, eight domestic legs, one international carrier for the diaspora audience.	\$2 street food → World-class resort
03 Spirits & wine Cocktails in Manila, champagne on the sand, tuba and lambanog in the provinces.	04 Luxury travel Yachts, island transfers, private dining, the Palawan and Boracay hours.	Grandmother's kitchen → Michelin-level chef
05 Swimwear & wellness Sunrise movement, spa, diving, sailing: the Indulge block in every episode.	06 Food & kitchen Cook It With Todd: eighty recipe moments with room for pans, knives, sauces, coconut products.	Fishing boat → Private yacht
07 Tourism board A love letter to eight regions, aligned with the national food-tourism push.	08 Remittance & telecoms The diaspora is the second audience; the brands that connect them are natural partners.	Market at sunrise → Spa at sunset
		Ancient recipe → Todd English interpretation

the plan

When and How to Shoot

The dry season, November to May, is the window for all eight hubs. Fiesta dates fix Iloilo and Cebu in January; the Giant Lantern Festival fixes Pampanga in December.

Jan SINULOG · DINAGYANG · ATI-ATIHAN	Feb PEAK DRY	Mar PEAK DRY	Apr FILIPINO FOOD MONTH	May HOT · MANGO SEASON	Jun HABAGAT BEGINS	Jul WET	Aug IBALONG · WET	Sep PEÑAFRANCIA · TYPHOON PEAK	Oct MICHELIN · TYPHOON RISK	Nov AMIHAN RETURNS	Dec GIANT LANTERN FESTIVAL
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☒ Dry season · shoot window ☐ Wet season · typhoon exposure

Logistics

Gateway · Manila (NAIA); Clark for Pampanga. Domestic legs by Philippine Airlines and Cebu Pacific; El Nido flights now fly under Cebgo and Manila–El Nido moved to Clark in March 2026.

Furthest hop · every hub is under 90 minutes by air from Manila or Clark.

Language · English is an official language; crews, chefs and fixers work in English.

Incentives & partners

FDCP FilmPhilippines · Film Location Incentive Program: a 20% cash rebate up to ₱25M (about \$450K) for international projects using a Filipino line-production company, plus a possible 5% cultural bonus. Confirm 2026 cycle dates.

Department of Tourism · Love the Philippines; food-tourism push.

Windows · Philippine broadcasters and streamers; iWant for the diaspora.

Proposed shoot · two blocks (for discussion)

Block A · January · Cebu (Sinulog) → Bohol → Iloilo (Dinagyang) → Boracay (Ati-Atihan next door): four Visayan episodes inside one festival month, four shoot days each plus travel.

Block B · February–March · Manila → Pampanga → Palawan → Bicol: calm seas for El Nido, clearest skies for Mayon, Manila last for the contemporary-chef dinners.

Total · about 40 shoot days, 8 travel days, one crew, one second unit for the vertical engine.

Sensitivities & permits

Boracay · post-rehabilitation rules govern beach dining; the sunset table needs a permit and a compliant resort frontage.

El Nido · protected-area zoning; island cooking by arrangement with the LGU and resort partners.

Mayon · PHIVOLCS alert level and the 6-km danger zone decide how close the finale sits.

Indigenous communities · consent first, credit on screen.

the words

A Short Filipino Food Vocabulary

Adobo

Meat braised in vinegar, garlic, soy and bay: the national dish with a Spanish name and a native method.

Bagoong

Fermented shrimp or fish paste; the salt of kare-kare.

Batchoy

Iloilo noodle soup with pork, offal and chicharrón.

Bicol Express

Pork and chili stewed in coconut milk.

Boodle / kamayan

A feast laid on banana leaves, eaten by hand.

Calamansi

The small, sharp Philippine lime.

Carinderia

A neighbourhood eatery with pots on display.

Fiesta

A town or barangay feast day; the whole street cooks.

Gata

Coconut milk.

Halo-halo

“Mix-mix”: shaved ice, sweet beans, fruit, ube, leche flan.

Inasal

Chicken grilled over coals with annatto and calamansi.

Kare-kare

Oxtail in peanut sauce, served with bagoong.

Kinilaw

Raw fish cured in vinegar, ginger and chili.

Laing

Dried taro leaves cooked down in coconut milk and chili.

Lambanog / tuba

Coconut spirit; palm wine.

Lechon

Whole spit-roasted pig; Cebu’s is stuffed with lemongrass.

Lola

Grandmother; the keeper of the recipe.

Lumpia

Spring roll, fresh or fried.

Merienda

The afternoon snack meal.

Pancit

Noodles, in dozens of regional forms.

Pancit molo

Pork dumpling soup from Molo, Iloilo.

Pandesal

The morning bread roll.

Pasalubong

The gift you bring home from a trip.

Patis / suka

Fish sauce / vinegar: the two table condiments.

Pili

The Bicol nut, richer than a macadamia.

Pinangat

Taro leaves wrapped around fish or pork, simmered in coconut milk.

Sawsawan

The dipping sauce you mix yourself.

Sili

Chili; siling labuyo is the small hot one.

Silog

Garlic rice and egg with a cured meat: tapsilog, tocilog.

Sinigang

Sour tamarind soup.

Siopao

Steamed filled bun, from the Chinese baozi.

Sisig

Chopped pig’s head and liver on a sizzling plate; invented in Pampanga.

Tablea

Roasted cacao tablets for hot chocolate.

Tocino

Sweet-cured pork, a Pampanga specialty.

Turo-turo

“Point-point”: choose your food from the pots.

Ube

Purple yam.

The words that recur across all eight episodes.



The jeepney, Manila’s folk art on wheels, now being phased out



The rice terraces of the Cordillera: rice is the plate every dish is...

the fine print

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FOOD TRIP: INDULGE

TODD ENGLISH

The Philippines

Season One · 8 × 30 minutes · 80+ short-form pieces

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"That's the trip. This is the taste."